

its box. If you already have an older Android phone, make sure it is ready to hand over your digital life cleanly. Google's official Android setup guidance notes that when moving to a new device, users can copy apps, photos, contacts, messages and more during setup, either from an old device or from a cloud backup. It also warns that if you do not have the old device, you need your Google Account and password to restore data from the cloud.

So, before the new phone starts, open your old phone and do a quick audit. Check whether your contacts are saved to your Google account, not only to the phone or SIM. Open Google Photos and see whether backup is on, if you use it. Open WhatsApp and manually trigger a backup. Open your authenticator app and check whether it has its own transfer or cloud backup feature. Open your banking and UPI apps and make sure you know which SIM number they are linked to. If your old phone has a screen lock, know the PIN. If your Google account has two-factor authentication, make sure you can receive the code or approve the login.



This is not paranoia. It is preparation. A phone migration usually fails not because Android is incapable, but because the user discovers too late that one part of their digital life was never backed up.

Step-by-step: prepare your old Android phone

Open Settings > Google > Backup. The wording may differ slightly depending on your phone brand, but Google says Android backup can include app data, call history, contacts, settings, SMS and pictures and videos depending on your configuration. It also offers a manual Back up now option under the backup section.

Now open Contacts and check where your contacts are stored. If you see multiple accounts, clean up duplicates later, but ensure your primary contacts are linked to the Google account you will use on the new phone.

Next, open WhatsApp > Settings > Chats > Chat backup. Run a manual backup. If you use WhatsApp for work, family, apartment groups, school updates, bills and photos of every important document, this step matters more than almost anything else.

Open your UPI apps and note which mobile number is registered. Do not assume the new phone will magically know

which SIM is your payment SIM. In India, that assumption is how people lose half a day to failed verification attempts.

Finally, update all apps from the Play Store. A fully updated old phone usually transfers more smoothly than one limping along with ancient app versions.

Restore or start fresh?

During setup, Android will ask whether you want to copy apps and data from an old device. This is the first major decision.

Restoring is convenient. It brings back apps, settings, contacts, SMS, call logs and other data where supported. But a fresh setup can be better if your old phone was a disaster. If it had years of unused apps, unknown APKs, spammy notification permissions, duplicate launchers, shady wallpaper apps, battery drain, malware suspicion or family hand-me-down clutter, do not migrate the mess. Start fresh, sign in to your Google account, restore only contacts, photos and essential data, then install apps manually. Focus on restoring data, not bad habits.

The first boot: do not race it

Now switch on the new phone. Choose your language carefully. Indian users often live across languages: English interface, Hindi keyboard, Marathi voice typing, Tamil family groups, Hinglish search queries. You can change this later, but choosing your comfort language early makes setup less error-prone.

Connect to a stable Wi-Fi network if possible. Google's setup guidance recommends Wi-Fi during setup because updates and data transfer may need connectivity. If you are using mobile data, make sure you have enough data balance and good signal. A half-failed restore because the connection collapsed midway is a very avoidable annoyance.

When asked to copy apps and data, choose the method that fits your situation. Cable transfer is often faster and more reliable if both phones support it. Wireless transfer is convenient. Cloud restore is useful if the old phone is unavailable, damaged or already wiped. Whatever you choose, keep both phones charged and nearby.

Do not set up the phone while travelling in a cab, standing in a store, or waiting at an airport gate. Android setup rewards patience.

Step-by-step: power-user first boot

- Switch on the phone and tap Start.
- Choose your language and region.
- Connect to Wi-Fi.
- Insert SIMs if not already inserted, but do not panic if you want to configure SIM behaviour later.
- Choose whether to copy apps and data from an old phone.
- Sign in with your primary Google account.
- Set a strong screen lock before adding biometrics. Fingerprint and face unlock are convenient, but the PIN or password is still the foundation.